BRIGHTSTEPS INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

Mockeyville, Grand-Bassam, Côte d'Ivoire

Life Skills Scope and Sequence

Life Skills

Pre-Nursery to Grade 7

Pre-Nursery · Pre-K and KG · Grade 1–2 · Grade 3–4 · Grade 6–7

2026 – 2027 · Six modules · 18 lessons · Alternate Fridays with SEL

Companion unit plans: Pre-Nursery · Pre-K and KG · Grade 1–2 · Grade 3–4 · Grade 6–7

Internal planning document · October 2026

How to Use This Document

Life Skills at BrightSteps teaches the practical skills children need to look after themselves, their home, their money and their environment. It runs in six three-lesson modules on alternate Fridays, the Fridays when SEL is not taught. SEL teaches feelings and relationships; Life Skills teaches what children can *do* with their hands and their choices.

- **Learning by doing.** In every lesson children practise the skill for real: washing hands, pouring water, crossing a chalk road, counting change. Talk is short; practice is long.
- **Matched to age.** Each class group learns what children of that age are ready for. A 2-year-old learns to put rubbish in the bin; a 12-year-old audits the school's waste and plans a fix.
- **Low cost.** No lesson needs special equipment. Most materials are free (bottles, cartons, cloth scraps, leaves) or cost a few hundred francs at the market. See the Low-Cost Materials Kit below.
- **Our place.** Lessons use Grand-Bassam life: the beach and lagoon, the market, local foods, CFA francs, mobile money, the heat and mosquitoes.
- **Class groups.** Pre-Nursery has its own plans. Pre-K and KG are taught together. Grade 1–2, Grade 3–4 and Grade 6–7 are combined classes. Grade 5 has no students this year; when it does, it follows the Grade 3–4 extension lines.
- **Home practice.** Each module ends with one small task to practise at home, sent to families in English and French.

Internal planning document. In anything families see, describe the approach as inquiry-based learning. BrightSteps is not an IB World School or candidate school.

Framework

Six strands make up the programme. Each strand is one module, taught by the whole school at the same time.

Module	What children learn	Why it matters here
1. Taking Care of Me	Handwashing, teeth, dressing, personal care, getting organised	Hygiene stops the illnesses that keep children home from school
2. Healthy Body	Food, clean water, sleep, movement, heat and malaria	Local foods, hot weather and mosquitoes shape children's health every day
3. Staying Safe	Road, home, fire, water and beach safety; first aid; calling for help	Busy roads, gas bottles, charcoal stoves and strong sea currents are real risks
4. Helping at Home	Tidying, food preparation without heat, washing, sewing, caring for others	Children contribute at home and grow independent
5. Money Smart	Coins and notes, needs and wants, saving, shopping, budgeting, mobile money	Children handle money at the market and see mobile money used daily
6. Caring for Our Planet	Waste, recycling, water saving, planting, protecting the beach and lagoon	Plastic waste in the lagoon and on the beach is visible in Grand-Bassam

Emergency numbers taught in Module 3: Police **170** (also 110 or 111) · Pompiers **180** · SAMU **185**.

Year at a Glance

The whole school studies the same module at the same time, so families hear one message and displays stay shared.

Module	When (approx.)	Big question	SEL module at the same time	Life Skills Fridays
1. Taking Care of Me	Sep–Oct	How do I keep my body clean and get ready by myself?	We Belong Here	3
2. Healthy Body	Oct–Dec	What helps my body grow strong and stay well?	Feelings Have Names	3
3. Staying Safe	Jan–Feb	How do I stay safe, and what do I do if something goes wrong?	Calm and Focused	3
4. Helping at Home	Feb–Mar	How can I look after my home and the people in it?	Friends and Respect	3
5. Money Smart	Mar–May	How do I use money wisely?	Solving Problems Together	3
6. Caring for Our Planet	May–Jun	How can I look after the place where I live?	Caring for Our Community	3

This year only. From late October, about 14 Life Skills Fridays remain, depending on holidays and events. Start Module 1 now. Teach lessons 1 and 2 of every module, and lesson 3 whenever time allows. If a Friday is lost, merge lessons rather than skip a module, so children meet all six strands this year.

Grade 6–7 project. In Module 6, Grade 6–7 can run one project that counts for both Life Skills (Caring for Our Planet) and SEL (Caring for Our Community).

1. Taking Care of Me

Children move from washing hands with help to planning their own daily care routine and caring for their clothes.

Class group	Children learn to…	Signature activity
Pre-Nursery	Wash and dry hands with help; wipe nose and put the tissue in the bin; try to put on shoes; follow the toilet routine with help	Handwashing song at the basin
Pre-K and KG	Wash hands alone in six steps for 20 seconds; brush teeth for two minutes; dress themselves (buttons, shoes, jacket); cough into the elbow	Egg-carton teeth brushing
Grade 1–2	Know the key times to wash hands; explain how sugar harms teeth; pack their school bag from a list; fold their uniform; care for nails and hair	Glitter-germ handshake
Grade 3–4	Explain how germs spread; plan a daily care routine; hand-wash socks; organise their bag from the timetable	Spray-bottle sneeze test
Grade 6–7	Care for a growing body in the heat; plan and keep a morning routine; do their own laundry by hand; care for their uniform	Bucket laundry challenge

2. Healthy Body

Children move from naming fruits to planning a balanced day of meals on a market budget.

Class group	Children learn to…	Signature activity
Pre-Nursery	Name and taste local fruits; drink water; wash hands before eating; move and rest	Fruit tasting
Pre-K and KG	Sort everyday foods and sometimes foods; choose water over sweet drinks; know that active play and sleep help us grow	Food picture sort
Grade 1–2	Sort local foods into go (energy), grow (body-building) and glow (protection) foods; drink clean water; sleep under a mosquito net	Go, Grow, Glow market
Grade 3–4	Draw a balanced plate with local foods; spot sugar on labels; drink enough in the heat; prevent malaria and find standing water	Sugar spoon line-up
Grade 6–7	Plan a balanced day of meals within a budget; read drink labels; build healthy sleep, screen and movement habits	Market-price meal plan

Nutrition rule. Talk about energy, growth and strength, never body size or weight. Children are never weighed in these lessons and never asked to count calories.

3. Staying Safe

Children move from holding a grown-up's hand to giving first aid and making a home safety plan.

Class group	Children learn to…	Signature activity
Pre-Nursery	Hold a grown-up's hand near the road; stop at a line; only put food in their mouth; stay with their grown-up	Stop-at-the-line walk
Pre-K and KG	Stop, look and listen at the road; know medicines and cleaning products are not food; say their full name and a parent's name; go near water only with an adult	Chalk-road crossing
Grade 1–2	Cross with «look left, right, left»; follow bus rules; get out and stay out of a fire; know 170, 180 and 185; swim only with an adult	Emergency number song
Grade 3–4	Spot dangers at home (gas, charcoal, wires); treat a small cut, nosebleed or burn; make an emergency call; read beach flags; wear a helmet	Home hazard hunt
Grade 6–7	Check for danger, call for help and use the recovery position; make a home fire plan; act in a rip current; ride and cross safely	First-aid stations

Burns, always: cool the burn under cool running water for 20 minutes. Never put oil, toothpaste or butter on a burn.

4. Helping at Home

Children move from putting toys away to preparing a simple meal for a group and mending their own clothes.

Class group	Children learn to…	Signature activity
Pre-Nursery	Put toys back in their place; match shoes and socks in pairs; carry a cup or plate; wipe a table	Toys go home game
Pre-K and KG	Set the table; pour from a jug and wipe a spill; fold a cloth; sort socks by colour and pair	Pour and wipe station
Grade 1–2	Prepare a fruit salad with plastic knives; wash dishes in two basins; fold a T-shirt; follow a chore chart	Fruit salad chefs
Grade 3–4	Follow a simple no-cook recipe with measuring; thread a needle and sew a running stitch; hand-wash and hang a small item	Recipe readers
Grade 6–7	Plan and prepare a no-cook group meal safely; sew on a button and mend a tear; care safely for a younger child	Cold kitchen challenge

5. Money Smart

Children move from playing market with card money to budgeting an event and staying safe with mobile money.

Class group	Children learn to…	Signature activity
Pre-Nursery	Give and receive in a play market; use large card «coins»; keep tokens safe in a box	Our little market
Pre-K and KG	Play shop with picture prices; KG names real 25, 50 and 100 FCFA coins; tell needs from wants; save tokens in a jar	Need it or want it?
Grade 1–2	Name CFA coins and notes; pay exact amounts up to 500 FCFA; save towards a goal	Class shop
Grade 3–4	Give change from 500 and 1,000 FCFA; compare market prices; bargain politely; make a savings plan	Market detectives
Grade 6–7	Budget an event with real prices; spend, save and share; keep a mobile money PIN private and spot scams; plan a mini enterprise	Mobile money scam spotters

Coin safety. Children under five never handle real coins: they are a choking risk. Pre-Nursery and Pre-K use large card coins.

6. Caring for Our Planet

Children move from putting rubbish in the bin to running a school waste audit and a campaign to fix what they find.

Class group	Children learn to...	Signature activity
Pre-Nursery	Put rubbish in the bin; water a plant; turn off the tap with help; collect leaves and shells	Nature walk
Pre-K and KG	Sort paper, plastic and food waste; plant a bean; turn the tap off while soaping	Bean in a cup
Grade 1–2	Reduce, reuse and recycle; make something useful from waste; grow and observe plants	Rubbish to treasure
Grade 3–4	Explain how plastic reaches the lagoon and beach; start a compost; care for a school garden plot	Bottle compost
Grade 6–7	Audit the school's waste; make ecobricks and reusable bags; run a campaign for families and younger classes	School waste audit

Low-Cost Materials Kit

One kit per class lasts the year. Basins and first-aid supplies can be shared between classes. Prices are approximate market prices in FCFA; check them locally before buying.

Item	Used for	Approx. cost (FCFA)
Bar soap × 4	Handwashing, laundry	1,200
Plastic basins × 2	Handwashing, washing up, laundry	3,000
Plastic jug	Pouring, watering, rinsing	1,000
Demo toothbrush and toothpaste	Tooth care lessons	1,000
Reusable plastic plates and knives (set of 15)	Food lessons	3,000
Fruit and food for about four food lessons	Tasting, fruit salad, recipes	8,000
Dried beans from the market	Planting	200
Needles, thread and buttons	Sewing	1,000
Plasters and gauze	First-aid practice	2,000
Printing (card coins, passports, cards)	Money lessons, assessment	2,000
Total per class		**about 22,400**

Free materials to collect from families and around school: plastic bottles and caps, cans, egg cartons, cardboard boxes, newspapers, old clothes and pagne scraps, rice and flour sacks, jam jars, leaves, sticks, shells, sand, soil, product packets with labels, old T-shirts, real price lists from the market.

Safety Rules for Life Skills Lessons

- **Food.** Check every child's allergies before any food lesson. Everyone washes hands first. Food is washed, covered and eaten the same day.

- **Knives.** Pre-K to Grade 2 use plastic knives on soft fruit; an adult cuts anything hard. Grade 3–4 use blunt table knives. Grade 6–7 may use a small kitchen knife only with an adult beside them and after learning the knife rules.
- **No heat.** No cooking with fire, gas or electricity in class. Recipes are no-cook.
- **Cleaning.** Children use soap and water only. Bleach and cleaning products are shown as pictures, never handled.
- **Water.** Water activities use basins and jugs. Children are never near deep water during lessons.
- **Coins and small objects.** No real coins, beans or buttons with children under five without one-to-one adult supervision.
- **First aid.** Lessons teach awareness and when to get help. They are not a first-aid certificate. Real injuries go to the school's first-aid lead.
- **Heat.** Outdoor activities happen in the shade, with water available.

Assessment and Reporting

Life Skills is reported by practical observation and a short comment; it never receives a letter grade.

- **Life Skills Passport.** Each child from Pre-K up has a small paper passport. When a child shows a skill, the teacher stamps or signs it. Children take pride in filling it, and it costs only printing.
- **Three levels.** Each skill is marked: **Not yet · With help · On my own**.
- **Pre-Nursery.** A simple tick sheet per module, using the same three levels.
- **Report comment.** One or two sentences per term naming a skill the child has mastered and one to practise at home.
- **Student Led Conferences.** Children can show one Life Skills skill (folding, handwashing, making change) during the November and March conferences.

Topics Held for Parent Consultation

These topics are not in the six modules. They are held until families have seen the materials and given their views.

- Puberty, body changes and menstrual hygiene (Grades 5–7)
- Sexual and reproductive health
- Alcohol, tobacco and drugs
- Detailed body-safety lessons beyond the safe-adult baseline taught in SEL

Not held back. Any child who needs help or makes a disclosure is supported straight away, following the safeguarding policy, with the Designated Safeguarding Lead.

Home Links

Send one short message at the start of each module, English first, then French.

Module	English	Français
1. Taking Care of Me	This month we are learning to wash our hands and care for our bodies. Let your child show you the six handwashing steps before dinner.	Ce mois-ci, nous apprenons à nous laver les mains et à prendre soin de notre corps. Laissez votre enfant vous montrer les six étapes du lavage des mains avant le dîner.
2. Healthy Body	We are learning about healthy food, clean water and mosquito nets. Ask your child which foods give energy and which help us grow.	Nous apprenons l'alimentation saine, l'eau propre et l'importance de la moustiquaire. Demandez à votre enfant quels aliments donnent de l'énergie et lesquels aident à grandir.
3. Staying Safe	We are learning road, home and beach safety. Please help your child learn your phone number and the emergency numbers: Police 170, Pompiers 180, SAMU 185.	Nous apprenons la sécurité routière, à la maison et à la plage. Aidez votre enfant à apprendre votre numéro de téléphone et les numéros d'urgence : Police 170, Pompiers 180, SAMU 185.
4. Helping at Home	We are learning to help at home. Give your child one small job this week, such as setting the table or folding clothes.	Nous apprenons à aider à la maison. Confiez à votre enfant une petite tâche cette semaine : mettre la table ou plier le linge, par exemple.
5. Money Smart	We are learning about money, saving and needs and wants. Take your child to the market and let them help pay or count change.	Nous apprenons l'argent, l'épargne, les besoins et les envies. Emmenez votre enfant au marché et laissez-le vous aider à payer ou à compter la monnaie.
6. Caring for Our Planet	We are learning to reduce waste and care for our environment. Please send clean bottles, cartons or old cloth for our projects.	Nous apprenons à réduire les déchets et à protéger notre environnement. Merci d'envoyer des bouteilles propres, des cartons ou de vieux tissus pour nos projets.